Interview Practice Sheet (54 questions)

Answers are in **Luul-Team-Trunk-Based-Project.pdf**, section 12 (same numbers), and in `docs/INTERVIEW-QA.md`.

> **How to practise**
>
> 1) Read the question. 2) Answer **out loud** in under 60 seconds, without looking. 3) Check the answer and tick a box. 4) A question is done when you get it right 3 times on different days. Best: record yourself on your phone, or ask a friend to read the questions to you.

A. The basics

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
1	What is the difference between Git and GitHub?			
2	Explain trunk-based development in one or two sentences.			
3	What does "main is always deployable" mean in practice?			
4	If everyone merges daily, why do you still need pull requests?			
5	What is a feature flag?			
6	What is the difference between deploy and release?			

B. Trunk-based development in a team

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
7	How do developers, QA and lead engineers work together in your workflow?			
8	How long should a branch live, and why?			
9	How big should a pull request be?			
10	If code is merged before it is finished, how does QA test it?			
11	Why do you use squash merge?			
12	How do you build a feature that takes three weeks?			
13	How do you keep your branch up to date with main?			
14	How would you move a team from GitFlow to trunk-based development?			

C. Roles, permissions and security

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
15	How did you design GitHub permissions for developers, QA, leads and platform?			
16	What is CODEOWNERS and how did you use it?			
17	What's the difference between branch protection rules and rulesets?			

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
18	Who can deploy to production, and how is that enforced?			
19	Why manage GitHub settings with Terraform instead of clicking in the UI?			
20	How do you onboard and offboard an engineer?			
21	How do you keep secrets out of Git?			
22	What is OIDC in GitHub Actions and why use it?			

D. CI/CD and releases

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
23	Walk me through your pipeline, from commit to production.			
24	Which checks are required on a PR, and who owns each one?			
25	What does "build once, deploy many" mean?			
26	What is a merge queue and when do you need it?			
27	How do you version and release?			
28	How do you roll back a bad deployment?			
29	The pipeline is slow. How do you speed it up?			

E. What would you do if... (incident questions)

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
30	main is red right after two PRs were merged. What do you do?			
31	A developer pushed an AWS key to GitHub. What do you do?			
32	You and another developer conflict on business logic. How do you resolve it?			
33	QA finds a regression in staging and nobody knows which commit caused it.			
34	Prod has a bug, but main contains unfinished work. How do you hotfix?			
35	A teammate ran git reset --hard and lost their commits.			
36	A developer opens a 2,000-line PR after two weeks of work.			
37	A flaky test is blocking every PR.			

F. Hard follow-up questions

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
38	Isn't it risky to merge unfinished code into main?			
39	What if a lead approves a bad change?			
40	Don't feature flags become technical debt?			

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
41	Your merge queue is slow. Now what?			
42	Admins can bypass the rules. Isn't that a security hole?			
43	How do you measure whether trunk-based development is working?			
44	Some developers resist the change. How do you convince them?			

G. Working with developers (the developer's point of view)

#	Question	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
45	How do you, as a DevOps engineer, support developers day to day?			
46	A developer says: "It works on my laptop but CI fails." What do you do?			
47	QA's tests pass locally but fail in staging. How do you find the cause?			
48	What is the difference between unit tests and end-to-end tests, and who owns them?			
49	Why should configuration be separate from code?			
50	What is test-driven development and why does it help trunk-based teams?			
51	How do you decide when a feature flag can be removed, and who removes it?			
52	A developer wants to skip a failing required check to ship faster. What do you say?			
53	Which HTTP status codes should an API return, and why does DevOps care?			
54	How do health checks and /version help in production?			

Mock interview sets (about 20 minutes each)

Set	Questions	Focus
1	1, 2, 6, 7, 11, 15, 23, 28	Big picture: trunk-based, roles, pipeline
2	16, 18, 19, 21, 22, 30, 31, 42	Platform and security
3	10, 12, 26, 33, 34, 36, 38, 40	Teamwork with QA and leads
4	14, 25, 27, 29, 37, 41, 43, 44	Senior / hard follow-ups
5	45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 52, 53, 54	Working with developers

The 3 sentences to remember: 1) *Deploy is not release.* 2) *Revert first, fix forward second.* 3) *Rotate the secret first, clean history second.*